

FILE : T02_AI_Admin_Automation_2026-10-01_1649.md
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PURPOSE : Teacher lesson plan for "AI Admin Automation: Get Your Week Back" (self-paced).
READ FIRST: 00_IEBC_Teaching_Playbook_2026-10-01_1649.md
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T02 Teacher Guide: AI Admin Automation: Get Your Week Back

Format	Self-paced video course + monthly live Q&A and assignment review
Length	6 modules, about 5 hours of student time (about 75 minutes of video)
Level	Beginner
Demo business	Lakeside Home Services
Student deliverable	Three live automations (lead follow-up, appointment reminders, invoice reminders) + a personal prompt library + before/after hours

How this course is taught

The teacher teaches this course in two ways:

1. **Recording:** each module below is a recording outline. Record 2–4 videos per module following the Playbook video standard (§13.4).
2. **Supporting:** a monthly 60-minute live Q&A (plan at the end) and assignment reviews within 3 business days.

Teachers who re-record a module must keep the ★ points and the assignment unchanged.

Course-level objectives

Students can:

1. Find and rank the tasks eating their week (time audit).
2. Write reusable prompts that produce send-ready drafts with light editing.
3. Build and test a no-code automation with a trigger, actions and a check step.
4. Run three working automations and measure hours saved.

Tools

- Any mainstream AI assistant (free tier works)
- Any no-code automation tool with a free tier (teach the *pattern*; demo in one tool)

- A form tool, a spreadsheet, and the student's email and calendar
- Tool choice for the demo: pick one and use it in every video so students aren't confused. Mention in Module 3 that other tools work the same way.

Module 1: The time audit (2 videos, ~12 min)

Objective: Students track a week of tasks and choose their top 3 automation targets.

★ MUST TEACH:

1. Why start with an audit: *automating the wrong thing wastes more time than it saves.*
2. The scoring method: frequency × time per occurrence × frustration (1–3 each). Max 27.
3. The three-target rule: pick 3, not 10. Finish them before adding more.
4. Good first targets are **repetitive, rule-based and low-risk**. Bad first targets involve judgment, money movement or legal documents.

SHOW: Fill in the Time Audit worksheet for Lakeside: 12 tasks, scored. Top 3 end up as new-lead follow-up (27), appointment confirmations (18), overdue invoice reminders (18). **TRY/BUILD (on-screen card):** Download the worksheet. Track your tasks for 5 working days (or estimate from last week's calendar and email). Score them. Circle your top 3. **Watch for (in assignment reviews):** Students choosing huge, vague targets ("marketing"). Coach them to name one specific repeated task ("reply to website inquiries").

Assignment 1: Completed Time Audit with top 3 targets.

Not yet	Meets	Strong
Fewer than 8 tasks, or targets are vague	8+ tasks scored, 3 specific targets	Also includes current time per week for each target (the "before" number)

Module 2: AI assistants for daily admin (3 videos, ~15 min)

Objective: Students write prompts that produce usable drafts and save them in a library.

★ MUST TEACH:

1. The 4-part prompt: role, context, task, format.
2. Give examples of your voice: paste 2–3 past messages and say *"match this tone."*
3. Iterate in the same conversation instead of starting over.
4. The prompt library: a single document with a name, the prompt and a "fill in" placeholder for each.
5. ★ The mistake moment: show a draft that invents a policy ("we offer a 2-year warranty") that Lakeside doesn't have. Teach: *"Remove anything you didn't tell it."*
6. The data rule.

SHOW: Build three Lakeside prompts live: inquiry reply, quote cover note, review reply. Show a weak prompt first, then the 4-part version, side by side. **TRY:** Students copy the inquiry-reply prompt and run it on the demo email. **BUILD:** Students write prompts for their 5 most common messages. **Stretch:** Add "ask me clarifying questions first" and a checklist the AI must confirm (price, date, next step).

Assignment 2: Prompt library with 5 prompts + one before/after example.

Not yet	Meets	Strong
Prompts are one line, missing context or format	5 prompts with all 4 parts and placeholders	Includes voice examples and a quality checklist

Module 3: No-code automation basics (3 videos, ~15 min)

Objective: Students understand triggers, actions and connections, and build a test automation.

★ MUST TEACH:

1. **Trigger → action(s) → check.** Every automation, in every tool.
2. Connections (logging accounts into the tool) and why to use a business account, not personal.
3. **Test with fake data first.** Turn on only after 3 clean test runs.
4. Where automations fail: changed field names, expired logins, duplicate triggers. How to read the tool's run history.

SHOW: Build "web form → add row to spreadsheet → email the owner" for Lakeside. Run three tests. Break it on purpose (rename a form field) and show how the run history reveals the problem.

TRY: Students build the same automation with the demo form. **BUILD:** None yet (they build their own in Module 4). **Watch for:** Students skipping the test step. Repeat in the Q&A: the test step is required in the rubric.

Module 4: Follow-ups and reminders on autopilot (3 videos, ~15 min)

Objective: Students build their first real automation: a lead follow-up.

★ MUST TEACH:

1. Lead follow-up pattern: new inquiry → instant acknowledgment → same-day personal reply → follow-up in 2 days if no response.
2. Where AI fits: drafting the personal reply for a human to approve, not sending it unreviewed.
3. Appointment reminders: 24 hours before, with a reschedule link. No-show recovery message.
4. Review request after a job, sent only if the job is marked complete.
5. A "stop" rule: the sequence stops as soon as the customer replies.

SHOW: Lakeside inquiry form → instant acknowledgment email → task created for the office with an AI-drafted reply → 2-day follow-up if no reply. **TRY:** Students rebuild it with the demo data. **BUILD:** Students build it for their business and run 3 tests. **Stretch:** Add SMS (if their tool supports it) or a different message for after-hours inquiries. **Watch for:** Follow-ups that keep going after the customer replies. Check for the stop rule.

Assignment 3: Working lead follow-up automation (screenshot of the flow + run history with 3 successful tests).

Not yet	Meets	Strong
Not tested, or no stop rule	Tested 3×, stop rule present, human reviews AI draft	Also has after-hours handling or a reminder automation

Module 5: Invoices and getting paid (2 videos, ~10 min)

Objective: Students set up invoice templates and an overdue-reminder sequence.

★ MUST TEACH:

1. Templates and recurring invoices in their existing tool (most invoicing tools have both built in; use built-in features before building custom automations).
2. Reminder schedule: friendly at 3 days overdue, firm at 10, phone call task at 21.
3. ★ Never let AI change amounts, due dates or payment terms. Those come from the invoicing system only.
4. Connect payments to books (preview of the AI Bookkeeping course).

SHOW: Lakeside overdue-invoice sequence with three message drafts written with the Module 2 method. **BUILD:** Students set up their sequence (built-in reminders or automation).

Module 6: Keep it running (2 videos, ~8 min)

Objective: Students set up a weekly check routine and measure results.

★ MUST TEACH:

1. The 10-minute weekly check: run history, failed runs, replies that need a human.
2. When to add a human review step (money, complaints, anything public).
3. Measure: before hours (Module 1) vs. after hours for each automation. Real numbers only.
4. What to automate next: go back to the Time Audit list.

Assignment 4 (final): Before/after hours for the 3 automations + screenshots of all 3 working.

Not yet	Meets	Strong
Fewer than 3 automations working	3 working, before/after numbers recorded	Also a written weekly-check routine and a next-target plan

Monthly live Q&A and review session (60 min)

Time	Segment
0:00–0:05	Welcome, who's on which module (poll)
0:05–0:25	Fix-it clinic: 3–4 students share screens with a broken or stuck automation; teacher troubleshoots out loud using run history
0:25–0:40	Mini-lesson on whatever confused the most people this month (from reviewer notes)
0:40–0:55	Open questions
0:55–1:00	Reminders: assignment deadlines, survey

Prep: reviewer sends the teacher the 3 most common mistakes from the month's assignments.

Common questions

Question	Answer
"My automation ran twice."	Usually two triggers or a form that submits twice. Check run history; add a "only if this ID is new" filter.
"Can AI send replies without me checking?"	For simple acknowledgments, yes. For anything with prices, promises or complaints, keep a human review step.
"The free tier ran out of runs."	Reduce test runs, filter so only real leads trigger it, or upgrade once you know it's saving time.

Tool notes (update quarterly)

- Last verified: 2026-10-01. Record all demos in one automation tool and name it in Module 3.